

Research Article

Enhancing Data Integrity in Engineering Accreditation System via Event-Driven Blockchain Architecture

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Abstract

The accreditation of engineering programs under LAM Teknik in Indonesia requires robust and reliable data-handling operations that comply with stringent standards for data integrity, transparency, and system dependability. However, current centralized systems, particularly those reliant on PDDIKTI as the primary data source, face persistent challenges with data synchronization and are susceptible to single points of failure. This study presents an integrated framework that leverages Blockchain technology (Hyperledger Besu) alongside the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) to strengthen the security and integrity of accreditation data while maintaining compatibility with existing workflows. The proposed architecture employs Change Data Capture (CDC) technology, specifically Debezium and Apache Kafka, to continuously stream data changes from the accreditation platform's database to the blockchain. Secure communication and authentication are achieved through a dedicated REST API layer, and smart contracts on the blockchain record hashed data entries to ensure immutability. Concurrently, accreditation documents are distributed using an IPFS cluster, with only their content identifiers (CIDs) referenced on-chain. This integrated approach ensures data validity and tamper resistance across platforms while maintaining high performance. The results demonstrate that the framework provides a scalable and secure solution for accreditation systems, thereby supporting the digital transformation of higher education governance in Indonesia.

Keywords: Accreditation; Blockchain; Data Integrity; Event-Driven architecture; LAM Teknik

INTRODUCTION

The accreditation of higher education institutions plays a critical role in ensuring academic quality, institutional accountability, and public trust [1], [2], [3], [4], [5], [6], [7], [8], [9]. In Indonesia, LAM Teknik is responsible for assessing engineering study programs. The agency relies primarily on data from PDDIKTI, the centralized national higher education database managed by the Indonesian government. The accuracy, consistency, and dependability of this data are essential for guaranteeing impartial and transparent accreditation processes. However, centralized databases are susceptible to considerable vulnerabilities, including single points of failure, data inconsistencies, and risks of tampering or forgery [10].

Persistent concerns regarding data manipulation and credential fraud have caused a shift toward decentralized solutions, particularly blockchain and the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) [11], [12]. Recent studies show that integrating these technologies strengthens data integrity, facilitates traceability, and ensures secure decentralized storage across sectors such as education and public administration. Specifically, IPFS-based distributed storage addresses blockchain scalability boundaries by storing large data files off-chain and recording only their cryptographic hashes on the blockchain [13], [14].

While blockchain and the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) have been extensively examined for securing academic credentials and digital records, their application to large-scale, continuous institutional accreditation remains underexplored. Most blockchain-based educational schemes focus on issuing and verifying static digital diplomas or badges for individual learners [15], [16]. These approaches often fail to resolve the complex requirements of ongoing data integration, sustained auditability, and seamless interoperability among independent accreditation bodies and centralized government databases. Furthermore, integrating decentralized ledger technologies with legacy relational databases entails significant challenges, particularly when trying to avoid a complete revamp of existing data structures or disruption to organizational workflows [17], [18]. Dealing with these integration obstacles accentuates the significance of the current study.

Research Objectives

To handle these vulnerabilities and bridge the current technology gap, this study suggests the design and evaluation of an event-driven framework that integrates a private blockchain (Hyperledger Besu) with an IPFS cluster for LAM Teknik's accreditation system [19], [20]. The primary innovation entails using Change Data Capture (CDC) with Debezium and Apache Kafka, permitting continuous, real-time transfer of updates from the accreditation platform's centralized MySQL database to a decentralized network without altering the legacy database [21]. This approach records data changes as discrete events, stores documents on an IPFS cluster, and utilizes smart contracts on Hyperledger Besu to record only Content Identifiers (CIDs) and metadata. This questions the dominant assumption that blockchain integration requires abandoning existing centralized

databases [22], [23]. This approach makes certain that the proposed architecture is practical for higher education governance and applicable to related sectors such as e-government data management and health informatics, where instant data synchronization and integrity are essential.

The main objective of this study is to provide a scalable, tamper-resistant, and transparent solution for the accreditation process managed by LAM Teknik. The anticipated results show that the decentralized, event-driven system will enhance resistance to data tampering, support transparent auditability, and allow real-time synchronization with acceptable latency relative to conventional centralized models. This research attempts to establish a firm foundation for the reliable digital transformation of higher education governance in Indonesia [24], [25].

RELATED WORK

Blockchain technology has received considerable academic attention in higher education, particularly for managing and authenticating academic credentials. Multiple frameworks have been developed to combat credential fraud, which causes considerable economic and social risks globally. Initial initiatives such as Blockcerts and EduCTX facilitate the issuance of digital certificates secured by blockchain networks [26], [27]. Despite their advantages, these systems typically assign full responsibility for key management to students and lack automated synchronization features. Cerberus represents another major advancement, supplying a blockchain-based credential verification system that uses smart contracts to enable credential revocation. While Cerberus addresses practical fraud scenarios, its design relies on manual data entry and QR code scanning rather than on automated, real-time databases [28], [29].

Recent research has studied using the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) to tackle scalability limitations and the high cost of storing large documents directly on the blockchain. Solutions such as Verifi-Chain and HEDU-Ledger use IPFS as a decentralized, off-chain storage mechanism for large academic files, storing only their cryptographic hashes on the blockchain to ensure security. Although these distributed storage approaches significantly improve efficiency, most present models are primarily implemented as standalone decentralized applications (dApps) for individual diplomas [26], [27], [28], [29], [30], [31], [32], [33], [34].

A considerable technological gap remains due to the lack of native integration mechanisms inside existing systems for legacy relational databases utilized by national accreditation bodies. Recent developments in electronic medical records have proved the effectiveness of Change Data Capture (CDC) with Debezium and Apache Kafka for streaming updates from centralized databases to blockchain networks without disrupting database schemas. Building on these basic concepts, this study adapts and extends the event-driven CDC paradigm for application in the higher education accreditation sector. This method removes manual data entry and efficiently bridges the interoperability gap

between legacy centralized platforms such as PDDIKTI and contemporary decentralized ledgers[30], [35], [36].

METHODS

This study adapts a validated event-driven blockchain framework, initially designed for electronic medical records[37], to address the specific requirements of the higher-education accreditation process under LAM Teknik. The principal modification redirects the framework's emphasis from patient data privacy to institutional data transparency, traceability, and secure synchronization with the national database (PDDIKTI) [38], [39].

System Architecture Overview

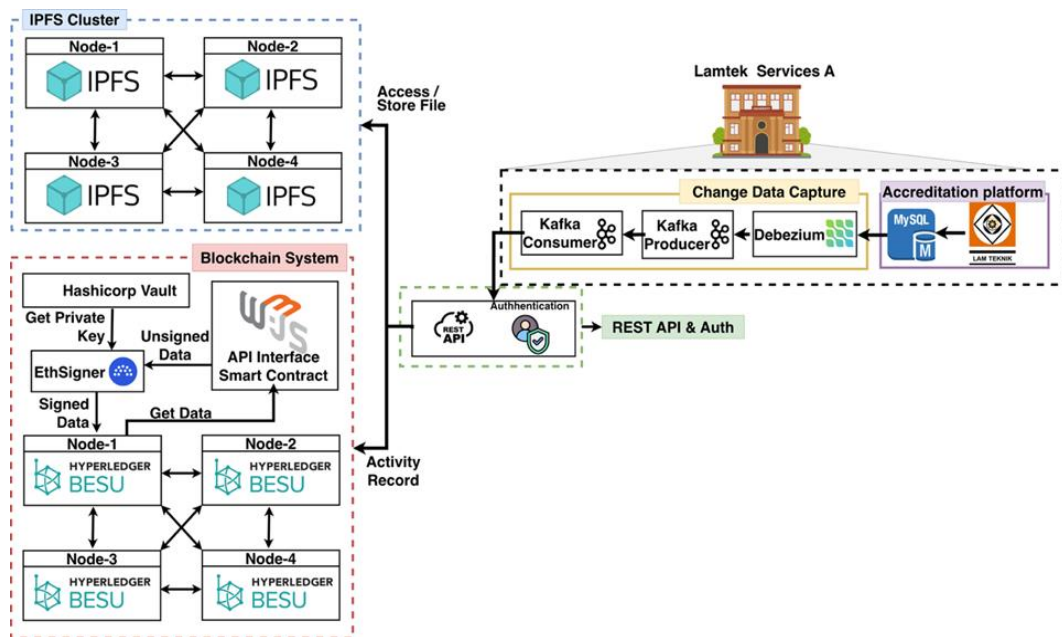


Figure 1. System Architecture Overview

The proposed framework aims to enable seamless integration between the centralized legacy database and decentralized components. As illustrated in Figure 1, the architecture comprises four primary layers: (1) the data source layer, which includes the LAM Teknik accreditation platform and the MySQL relational database; (2) the data capture and streaming layer, which utilizes Debezium and Apache Kafka; (3) the middleware layer, responsible for authentication and cryptographic signing through REST API, Hashicorp Vault, and EthSigner; and (4) the decentralized layer, which consists of a private blockchain network (Hyperledger Besu) and a distributed storage cluster (IPFS). This architecture preserves the existing legacy database schema, thereby preventing operational disruptions within the current accreditation workflow [30], [38], [39].

Event-Driven Data Synchronization via Change Data Capture

To achieve real-time synchronization without schema modification, Change Data Capture (CDC) is implemented using the Debezium connector. The CDC continuously

monitors the MySQL binary log (binlog) for any row-level modifications, such as INSERT, UPDATE, or DELETE operations related to accreditation documents. These operations are captured as events and streamed to Apache Kafka topics [40]. Let D represent the accreditation document or data being managed, and C_{new} denote any newly detected changes in the database. The change detection function $f(C_{new})$ identifies these modifications and can be mathematically expressed as follows:

$$f(C_{new}) = \text{detect_changes}(D) \quad (1)$$

By employing Apache Kafka as a high-throughput, low-latency message broker, the captured events are decoupled from the source database, allowing the Kafka Consumer service to securely fetch and process the messages for the downstream decentralized network.

Event Streaming Mechanics

The adoption of Change Data Capture (CDC) with the Debezium connector shifts traditional batch-processing synchronization to a real-time data streaming model. Debezium reads the MySQL binary log (binlog) of the LAM Teknik accreditation platform, which sequentially records every committed row-level modification [41], [42]. Upon updates to accreditation documents[14], Debezium captures both the previous and current states of the affected row, encapsulates this change in an event payload, and publishes it to a specified Apache Kafka topic. Employing Apache Kafka as a message broker separates the legacy database from the decentralized network. The Kafka Consumer service subscribes to these topics, deserializes the JSON payloads, and routes the data to the blockchain and InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) pipelines. This architecture removes the single point of failure and ensures that the legacy database does not experience additional computational load during synchronization[43], [44].

Distributed Storage via IPFS and Merkle DAG

Because blockchain networks are not optimized for efficiently storing large files, a hybrid storage strategy is adopted in this study. Directly storing large accreditation documents, such as PDF evidence files, on the blockchain is both economically unfeasible and technically inefficient due to block size limitations and transaction latency [43], [44], [45]. Therefore, the heavy accreditation documents are stored off-chain in an IPFS cluster. Consequently, these documents are stored off-chain within an InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) cluster. In this decentralized file system, each file is divided into smaller blocks, typically 256 KB in size. The blocks are organized into a Merkle Directed Acyclic Graph (Merkle DAG), with each node assigned a unique cryptographic hash generated by the SHA-256 algorithm. The root hash of the Merkle DAG functions as the Content Identifier (CID) for the entire[22], [46].

Following the detection of changes, the data is synchronized with IPFS using the function g , described as:

$$g(D, C_{new}) = \text{sync_to_ipfs}(D, C_{new}) \quad (2)$$

The total synchronization time T_{sync} required for this process is modeled as the sum of the IPFS upload time and the processing time:

$$T_{\text{sync}} = T_{\text{upload_ipfs}} + T_{\text{processing}} \quad (3)$$

Altering even a single byte of the accreditation document triggers the avalanche effect of the SHA-256 algorithm, resulting in a significant change to the root content identifier (CID) and immediate loss of document integrity. To maintain data availability and prevent automatic garbage collection of essential documents, the IPFS pinning service is employed, which compels cluster nodes to retain the file permanently (Arissabarno, Sukaridhoto, et al., 2024; Babu et al., 2023).

Blockchain Integration and IBFT 2.0 Consensus Protocol

After the document is successfully stored in IPFS, only the generated content identifier (CID) and its associated metadata are recorded on-chain in the Hyperledger Besu network. Due to the strict privacy and governance requirements of higher education accreditation, a permissionless public blockchain is deemed unsuitable. Therefore, this study employs Hyperledger Besu configured as a permissioned private consortium network, utilizing the Istanbul Byzantine Fault Tolerance 2.0 (IBFT 2.0) Proof of Authority (PoA) consensus mechanism. Under IBFT 2.0, consensus is established through a multi-phase voting process among authorized validator nodes representing trusted entities, such as LAM Teknik and PDDIKTI (Hsu et al., 2020; Yang et al., 2022). The protocol ensures immediate finality, so once a block containing the accreditation CID is added to the chain, it cannot be altered or reverted. Furthermore, IBFT 2.0 can tolerate the failure or malicious behavior of up to f nodes in a network of N nodes, provided that:

$$N \geq 3f + 1$$

The recording of these changes on the blockchain via the transaction function T is expressed as:

$$T(D, C_{new}) = \text{record_transaction}(D, C_{new}) \quad (4)$$

Consequently, the total transaction time $T_{\text{transaction}}$ encompasses the hashing process and the blockchain recording phase:

$$T_{\text{transaction}} = T_{\text{hashing}} + T_{\text{recording}} \quad (5)$$

SmartContract Implementation

A Solidity-based smart contract is deployed on the Hyperledger Besu network to manage accreditation data. In contrast to previous methods that associated variables with individual identifiers such as National Identification Numbers, the present study adapts the contract for use with institutional accreditation entities. The smart contract maintains essential variables, including `university_code` (the unique identifier for the university),

prodi_code (the identifier for the academic program), cid (the content identifier from IPFS), timestamp, and action (indicating whether the operation was an upload, update, or soft-delete). Each time the setDocument() function is executed, an event is emitted to record all actions, thereby providing a transparent, tamper-proof, and traceable audit trail for the LAM Teknik accreditation process.

The smart contract manages several essential variables, including:

- universityCode: Unique identifier of the university
- prodiCode: Identifier of the study program
- cid: Content Identifier (CID) of the document stored in IPFS
- timestamp: Time of transaction recording
- action: Type of operation (Upload, Update, Delete)
- sender: Address of the transaction initiator.

Algorithm 1. Smart Contract: Accreditation Document Management

```

Data: Initialize
    akreditasiId: string indexed
    universityCode: string
    prodiCode: string
    cid: string
    timestamp: uint
    action: string
    sender: address,
Mapping: records[akreditasiId] → Record
Array: akreditasiIds[]
Mapping: recordExists[akreditasiId] → boolean
Result: Stored akreditasiId, universityCode, prodiCode, cid,
timestamp, action, sender on blockchain
Event event DataAccreditation(akreditasiId: string, cid: string,
action: string, timestamp: uint)
Function setDocument(akreditasiId, universityCode, prodiCode, cid,
action, timestamp):
    isNew ← NOT recordExists[akreditasiId];
    Set records[akreditasiId] ← {
        akreditasiId,
        universityCode,
        prodiCode,
        cid,
        timestamp,
        action,
        sender = msg.sender
    };
    IF isNew THEN
        akreditasiIds.push(akreditasiId);
        recordExists[akreditasiId] ← true;

```

```

END IF
Emit DataAccreditation event with
(akreditasiId, cid, action, timestamp);
Return true;

```

The interaction among the smart contract, IPFS, and the data capture mechanism can be modeled as a sequence of functions that represent change detection, data synchronization, and blockchain recording. Equation (6) defines the change detection process, where D represents the accreditation data stored in the database, and C_{new} denotes newly detected changes. The function f captures modifications, such as insert, update, and delete operations, through the CDC mechanism. Equation (7) describes the synchronization process to IPFS. The function g takes both the original data D and the detected changes C_{new} , then stores the updated document in IPFS and generates a unique content identifier (CID). Equation (8) models the synchronization time, which T_{sync} is composed of the upload time to IPFS and additional processing time, including encoding and validation. Equation (9) represents the blockchain recording process, where the function T encodes the updated data and submits it as a transaction to the blockchain network. Equation (10) defines the total transaction time, consisting of the time required to generate cryptographic hashes and to record the transaction in the blockchain ledger.

$$f(C_{new}) = \text{detect_changes}(D) \quad (6)$$

$$g(D, C_{new}) = \text{sync_to_ipfs}(D, C_{new}) \quad (7)$$

$$T_{sync} = T_{upload_ipfs} + T_{processing} \quad (8)$$

$$T(D, AC_{new}) = \text{record_transaction}(D, C_{new}) \quad (9)$$

$$T_{transaction} = T_{hashing} + T_{recording} \quad (10)$$

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

A comprehensive analysis was conducted to evaluate the effectiveness of the event-driven blockchain framework in the LAM Teknik accreditation process. The evaluation includes a comparative analysis with traditional centralized systems, an assessment of the event-driven integration pipeline, performance benchmarking of the upload process, an examination of traceability and audit trails, and a comprehensive security and scalability assessment[47].

Implementation Environment

The proposed system is deployed on a Docker Swarm cluster architecture comprising one manager node and multiple worker nodes. Each node operates within a virtual machine environment to facilitate scalability and efficient orchestration. The manager node is provisioned with a dual-core CPU, 8 GB RAM, and 100 GB of storage, running Ubuntu

Server 24.04.3 LTS. This node manages cluster orchestration, service scheduling, and overall system coordination. Worker nodes are configured with a dual-core CPU, 4 GB of RAM, and 35 GB of storage, and run Ubuntu Server 24.04.3 LTS. These nodes execute distributed services, including blockchain nodes, Kafka brokers, IPFS nodes, and middleware. This distributed architecture provides high availability, fault tolerance, and optimal resource utilization, thereby supporting the event-driven architecture described in this research.

Comparative Analysis of the Proposed Architecture

Table 1. Comparative Analysis between Traditional System and Proposed Blockchain-IPFS System

Metric	Traditional System	Blockchain-IPFS System	Improve ment
Data Integrity	Vulnerable to tampering	Immutable (hash-based)	High
Security	Centralized vulnerability	Decentralized & encrypted	High
Transparency	Limited auditability	Full traceability	High
Fault Tolerance	Single point of failure	Distributed nodes	High
Scalability	Limited	High (Kafka + IPFS)	Medium-High
Data Consistency	Manual synchronization	Real-time (CDC + Kafka)	High

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Table 2. Comparative Analysis between Traditional System and Proposed Blockchain-IPFS System

Component	Traditional System	Proposed System
Database	MySQL	MySQL + CDC
Storage	Centralized	IPFS
Data Verification	Manual	Blockchain-based
Data Synchronization	Batch Processing	Real-time (Kafka)
Security Mechanism	Basic Authentication	Vault + EthSigner

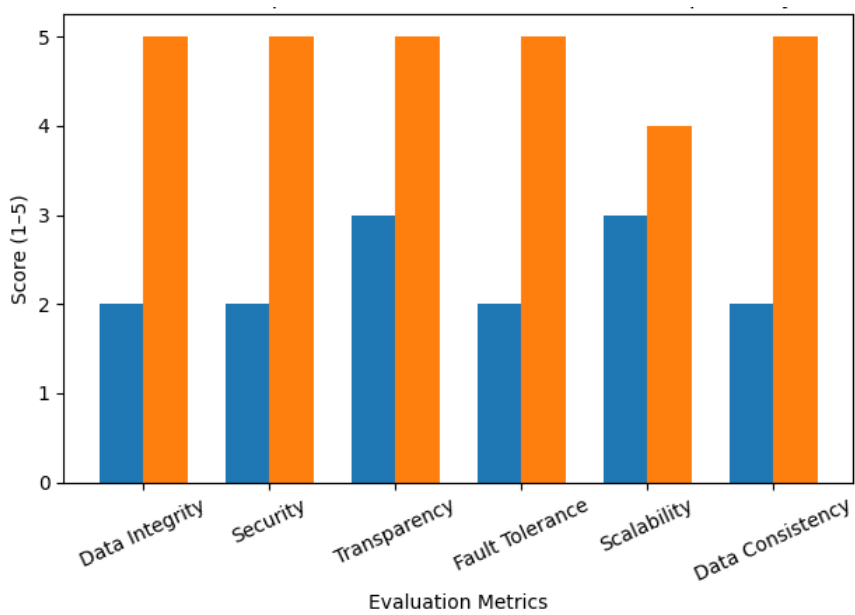


Figure 2. Performance Comparison between Traditional and Proposed System

The qualitative performance evaluation, as shown in Figure 2, indicates that the proposed decentralized architecture consistently surpasses the traditional system across key metrics, particularly data integrity, security, and transparency. Storing only cryptographic hashes and Content Identifiers (CIDs) on-chain, while maintaining large evidence files off-chain in IPFS, significantly reduces the risk of data manipulation [41], [45]. These results align with recent studies demonstrating that hybrid blockchain-IPFS architectures address the storage limitations of conventional blockchains and substantially improve data immutability and fault tolerance in higher education data governance)[43], [44], [45].

Event-Driven Integration and Upload Performance

To evaluate the proposed event-driven integration, an end-to-end experimental scenario was conducted covering the complete pipeline from database change capture to decentralized storage and blockchain recording. The system utilizes Change Data Capture (CDC) with Debezium to capture database changes from MySQL, which are then streamed to Apache Kafka. The incoming events are processed by a connector service that separates data into two categories: DataQuery and DataFile. DataQuery is forwarded directly to the smart contract, while DataFile is first uploaded to IPFS and then recorded on the blockchain using its corresponding hash. Additionally, delete operations are transformed into soft-delete events to preserve data traceability[30].

Table 3. Validation of Event-Driven Integration Pipeline

Test ID	Scenario	Status	Key Result
S8-T01	CDC normalization & delete handling	PASS	Soft-delete applied, trace preserved
S8-T02	DataQuery routing	PASS	Smart contract executed correctly

S8-T03	DataFile processing	PASS	IPFS upload and blockchain recording successful
S8-T04	Kafka consumer execution	PASS	DataQuery and DataFile pipelines active
S8-T05	Signing mechanism	PASS	External and Vault-based signing validated
S8-T06	Blockchain transaction	PASS	Valid transaction hashes generated

The implementation of the proposed architecture depends on seamless integration between the legacy database and the decentralized network. Table 3 displays validation results for the event-driven integration pipeline. These results indicate that Change Data Capture (CDC) with Debezium accurately normalizes database events and manages deletions by converting them into soft-delete events (S8-T01), thereby preserving historical data records. The Kafka consumer efficiently routes DataQuery and DataFile pipelines, executes smart contracts, and initiates IPFS uploads as intended (S8-T02 to S8-T04). These findings demonstrate that blockchain networks can interoperate with legacy relational databases in real time without necessitating disruptive schema modifications, thus addressing a significant integration challenge identified in prior research.

Table 4. Performance Benchmark of Upload Process

Scenario	Mode	File Size (KB)	Iterations	Avg Latency (ms)	P95 (ms)	Min (ms)	Max (ms)	Std Dev (ms)	Throughput (MB/s)	IPFS Calls	Blockchain Calls	Kafka Calls
sync-256kb	Sync	256	80	0.457	0.622	0.334	1.004	0.104	547.160	80	80	0
sync-1024kb	Sync	1024	80	1.592	1.911	1.287	2.078	0.211	628.088	80	80	0
sync-5120kb	Sync	5120	50	7.889	9.309	6.660	13.317	1.170	633.769	50	50	0
kafka-256kb	Kafka	256	80	1.112	1.560	0.561	5.317	0.555	224.757	0	0	80
kafka-1024kb	Kafka	1024	80	2.625	4.639	1.284	8.658	1.218	380.965	0	0	80
kafka-5120kb	Kafka	5120	50	14.268	36.869	6.707	61.926	10.115	350.431	0	0	50

System scalability was further evaluated by benchmarking upload performance under two processing modes: synchronous and Kafka-based event-driven workflows, across varying file sizes. As shown in Table 4, synchronous processing consistently achieved lower latency across all file sizes than the Kafka-based mode. Experimental testing with

Hyperledger Besu and IPFS revealed that uploading to IPFS requires approximately 0.7 seconds per MB, blockchain transaction processing averages 4.2 seconds, and CDC integration time is about 1.1 seconds per MB. In contrast, transactional latency for a Hyperledger Fabric implementation stabilizes at approximately 45 ms for consecutive reads and writes [38]. The increased latency and standard deviation observed in the Kafka-based approach are primarily attributed to the overhead from message serialization and distributed event streaming. Nevertheless, the Kafka-based mode remains preferable for large-scale accreditation systems due to its enhanced decoupling, fault tolerance, and asynchronous processing capabilities.

Traceability, Audit Trail, and Data Integrity

A critical requirement for the LAM Teknik accreditation process is the secure traceability and auditability of document submissions and modifications. The traceability verification results, as presented in Table 5, demonstrate that all necessary cryptographic attributes, including IPFS CIDs, SHA-256 hashes, transaction hashes, and precise timestamps, are accurately captured and recorded on-chain. Within the Kafka-based workflow, a unique referenceId (UUID v4) effectively links the initial HTTP request, the Kafka event stream, the IPFS storage location, and the Hyperledger Besu transaction record. Comprehensive validation confirms that each state transition, such as document uploads or updates, is immutably logged with its associated metadata (kodeAkreditasi, tipeDokumen). This tamper-resistant audit mechanism directly mitigates the widespread risks of credential fraud and data inconsistencies prevalent in traditional educational databases [48].

Table 5. Traceability Verification Results

Check	Expected	Actual	Status
Sync response contains IPFS hash	Yes	Yes	PASS
Sync response contains SHA-256	Yes	Yes	PASS
Sync response contains Tx Hash	Yes	Yes	PASS
Sync response contains URL	Yes	Yes	PASS
Kafka response queued	Yes	Yes	PASS
Kafka response contains referenceId	Yes	Yes	PASS
Kafka topic correct	Yes	Yes	PASS
Kafka message payload exists	Yes	Yes	PASS
referenceId format valid (UUID v4)	Yes	Yes	PASS
Event operation field	Upload	Upload	PASS
Event contains kodeAkreditasi	Yes	Yes	PASS
Event contains tipeDokumen	Yes	Yes	PASS
Event contains fileName	Yes	Yes	PASS
Event contains mimeType	Yes	Yes	PASS
Event contains contentBase64	Yes	Yes	PASS
Event contains metadata	Yes	Yes	PASS
Event contains timestamp	Yes	Yes	PASS

Security Analysis and CIA Triad Compliance

The robustness of the proposed framework was evaluated against the fundamental principles of information security: Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability (CIA Triad) (Arissabarno et al., 2025).

1. Confidentiality: While the blockchain ledger guarantees transparency, sensitive metadata is protected through permissioned access controls inherent in Hyperledger Besu. Confidentiality is maintained because only authorized institutional nodes within the consortium (LAM Teknik and PDDIKTI) are granted the cryptographic keys required to read and write transactions. Furthermore, the IPFS network only stores encrypted hashes, ensuring that unauthorized external parties cannot decipher the underlying accreditation evidence without the proper access credentials.

2. Integrity: Data integrity is the cornerstone of this architecture. The integration of Debezium ensures that every modification in the source database is exactly mirrored in the decentralized storage. The usage of SHA-256 hashing in IPFS CIDs and the immutable block linkage in Hyperledger Besu make retroactive data manipulation mathematically impossible. Any attempt to alter an academic record post-accreditation would result in a hash mismatch, instantly flagging the data as corrupted.

3. Availability: Centralized servers are prone to becoming single points of failure. By distributing documents across an IPFS cluster with multiple nodes, the system ensures strong redundancy. Should any node go down, accreditation documents remain accessible from other nodes in the network, ensuring consistent data availability at all times.

System Scalability and Storage Efficiency

As the volume of data shared on the blockchain increases, the inability to remove data from the chain results in significant storage demands and may lead to network congestion. Storing large accreditation documents, such as PDF files and institutional portfolios, directly on the blockchain is neither cost-effective nor efficient due to block size limitations and transaction delays[49], [50]. To address these challenges, the proposed system implements a hybrid data storage approach that integrates on-chain and off-chain methods. By transferring large data storage to the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) platform, this approach substantially reduces on-chain storage requirements. Experimental results indicate that this secure storage solution maintains minimal blockchain space usage, even as the total data size increases from 1 MB to 40 MB. This consistency is achieved because only the encrypted cryptographic hash is stored on-chain, and the hash size remains constant regardless of the amount of data stored off-chain. Consequently, the system mitigates blockchain bloat and achieves higher throughput compared to approaches that rely exclusively on on-chain storage.

Implementation Challenges and the Indonesian Context

Despite the significant technological advantages, the widespread adoption of the blockchain-IPFS framework in Indonesia's higher education sector faces several non-technical obstacles. First, moving from a centralized data governance approach to a

decentralized consortium model necessitates robust regulatory backing and adaptable policies from the Ministry of Education and associated legal authorities. At present, laws governing the legal standing of blockchain-based digital signatures and smart contract implementation in national accreditation are still underdeveloped.

Second, integrating blockchain technology with conventional government data centers demands substantial architectural redesign and modifications to accommodate differing data structures. Addressing these challenges requires strategic alignment with national initiatives, such as the Satu Data Indonesia (SDI) and explorations by the Central Statistics Agency (BPS), which have begun to acknowledge the role of blockchain in safeguarding national data. Lastly, maintaining a distributed IPFS cluster and blockchain validator nodes requires substantial initial infrastructure investments and capacity-building to address the shortage of blockchain-skilled professionals at universities. However, these initial costs are more than offset by the long-term elimination of third-party auditing expenses and the substantial reduction in administrative overhead associated with manual credential verification.

CONCLUSIONS

This study developed and evaluated a decentralized, event-driven framework that integrates a private blockchain (Hyperledger Besu) and the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) to enhance the security of the engineering accreditation process under LAM Teknik. A key contribution is the integration of decentralized technologies with a legacy centralized relational database using Change Data Capture (CDC) and Apache Kafka. This method bridges the technological gap without necessitating major modifications to the existing database schema, thereby enabling continuous, real-time synchronization.

The results demonstrate that the proposed framework significantly improves data integrity, transparency, and fault tolerance relative to traditional centralized architectures. Although the event-driven Kafka-based pipeline introduces a slight latency overhead due to message serialization, this is offset by the benefits of asynchronous decoupling, large-scale scalability, and enhanced system reliability. The architecture distributes large evidentiary documents off-chain using the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS), while only cryptographic Content Identifiers (CIDs) and metadata are recorded on-chain through smart contracts, ensuring a tamper-proof audit trail. This approach reduces vulnerabilities associated with single points of failure and data manipulation, offering a reliable model for digital transformation in higher education governance in Indonesia. Future research should investigate cross-chain interoperability to link independent accreditation networks with governmental databases and further refine the consensus mechanism to minimize latency.

Author Contributions

Conceptualization, S.S. and P.P.; methodology, S.S. and P.P.; software, S.S. and P.P.; validation, S.S., P.P., R. and M.A.A.; formal analysis, S.S. and P.P.; investigation, S.S., P.P. and R.; resources, R. and M.A.A.; data curation, S.S. and P.P.; writing—original draft preparation, S.S. and P.P.; writing—review and editing, S.S., P.P., R. and M.A.A.; visualization, S.S. and P.P.; supervision, R.; project administration, S.S. All authors have read and agreed to the published version of the manuscript.

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CONFLICT OF INTERESTS

The authors should confirm that there is no conflict of interest associated with this publication.

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